

If you're preparing to **record yourself attempting to recover your OSF account**, the smartest move is to treat the recording like a **forensic capture session** — clear, chronological, and self-contained. You don't need anything fancy; you just need to show:

- what you tried
- what the system returned
- and that you acted in good faith

Here's a structure you can follow so the recording becomes strong evidence later.

How to Record Your OSF Account Recovery Attempt (Forensic-Grade Structure)

1. Start with a short verbal intro

Keep it clean and factual:

- Your name
- The date and time
- The purpose of the recording
- A brief statement that the OSF account previously existed and is now inaccessible

Example phrasing:

“This is Spencer, recording on January 18, 2026. I am documenting my attempt to regain access to my OSF account, which previously contained active projects and has since been deactivated. This recording captures the full recovery attempt.”

2. Show your screen and navigate to OSF

Record the entire navigation path:

- Open browser
- Go to <https://osf.io>
- Show the login page

This proves you're not editing or staging anything.

3. Attempt every official recovery method

Walk through each one on camera:

A. Standard login

- Enter your email
- Enter your password
- Show the error message

B. “Forgot Password” flow

- Enter the same email
- Show whether OSF recognizes it
- Show whether a reset email is sent or rejected

C. Check your email inbox

- Show whether OSF sent anything
- Show timestamps
- Show spam/junk folder

D. Try alternate emails (if applicable)

Only if you ever used more than one.

E. Attempt institutional login (if you originally used one)

If you used:

- Google
- ORCID
- University SSO

Show the result.

4. Attempt to access your old project URLs

If you have:

- direct project links
- file links
- DOI links
- public pages

Open them on camera.

If they return:

- 404
- “This project is private”
- “This account has been disabled”
- “You do not have permission”

...that becomes strong evidence.

5. Attempt to contact OSF support

On camera:

- Navigate to OSF support page
- Show the contact form
- Fill it out
- Submit it
- Show confirmation

If they require email, record yourself sending the email.

6. End with a verbal summary

Something like:

“This recording documents that I attempted all official OSF recovery methods. The account remains inaccessible, and the system does not recognize my credentials or recovery email. This concludes the recovery attempt.”



Optional: I can write a script for you

If you want a **word-for-word script** to read during the recording, I can generate that next.



Optional: I can also create a README for your evidence repo

If you want the recording to be part of a structured evidence package, I can generate:

- a README
- a continuity timeline
- an evidence index
- a chain-of-custody statement

Just tell me what you want to add.

You're thinking about this exactly the right way—treat it like a controlled incident response with a defined window, tiers, and full evidentiary capture.

Here's a tight structure you can use for your **three-tier reactivation and explanation series over 5 days**.

Overall frame

Objective:

Document, in a reproducible and time-bounded way, that you:

- attempted in good faith to reactivate the OSF account
- followed all visible and reasonable channels
- recorded every interaction and system response
- preserved all artifacts in a vault-ready structure

Window:

5 days, with three escalating tiers of contact and explanation.

Tier 1 — Direct system interaction (Day 1–2)

Goal: Exhaust all self-service and visible OSF mechanisms.

- **Actions:**
 - **Login attempts:** normal login, password reset, alternate login methods (SSO, ORCID, etc.).
 - **Recovery flows:** “Forgot password”, “Need help logging in”, any visible recovery links.
 - **Direct URL access:** old project links, DOIs, public pages, profile URL.
 - **Recording:**
 - Full-screen video of each attempt.
 - Verbal narration: date, time, what you’re doing, what you expect, what actually happens.
 - **Artifacts to vault:**
 - Screen recordings
 - Screenshots of errors
 - Any emails received (or not received) from OSF
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Tier 2 — Formal support contact (Day 2–3)

Goal: Demonstrate that you escalated through official human channels.

- **Actions:**
 - Use OSF’s support/contact form (on camera).
 - Send a **clear, concise email** to support (and any listed admin contact).
 - If available: open a ticket through any institutional or helpdesk portal.
 - **Content of message:**
 - Identify the account (email, username, approximate creation date).
 - State that the account previously existed and is now inaccessible.
 - Request reactivation or export of data.
 - Ask for confirmation that the account exists in their system.
 - **Recording:**
 - Screen recording of composing and submitting forms/emails.
 - Save sent emails as PDFs.
 - **Artifacts to vault:**
 - Copies of all messages sent
 - Auto-replies or ticket numbers
 - Any human responses
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Tier 3 — Clarifying explanation & final escalation (Day 4–5)

Goal: Create a final, unambiguous record that you:

- explained the situation clearly

- requested specific actions
- gave them a reasonable response window

Actions:

- **Follow-up email** referencing:
 - prior attempts (with dates)
 - lack of resolution or response
 - the importance of the account and its contents
- **Clarify requests:**
 - Confirm whether the account exists and its status (active, disabled, deleted).
 - Request either:
 - reactivation, or
 - export of all associated data, or
 - written confirmation that the account and its contents are no longer recoverable.
- **Recording:**
 - Screen recording of drafting and sending the follow-up.
 - Optional: short video log summarizing the 5-day sequence.

Artifacts to vault:

- Final email(s)
- Any responses or lack thereof (screenshots of empty inbox at key checkpoints)
- A short written summary of the 3-tier process and outcomes

Suggested repo structure for vaulting

You can mirror this in a repo or vault like:

- **/tier-1-system-interactions/**
 - videos, screenshots, error messages
- **/tier-2-support-contact/**
 - PDFs of emails, ticket confirmations, support forms
- **/tier-3-final-escalation/**
 - follow-up emails, final logs
- **/summary/**
 - **timeline.md** — dates, actions, outcomes
 - **chain-of-custody.md** — how and when evidence was captured

If you want, I can write:

- the **exact email templates** for each tier, or

- a **timeline.md** skeleton you can drop straight into your vault.